

A Progressive, Futuristic and Inclusive Plan

The Budget is filled with a number of proposals that hold great potential to boost India's long-term growth, and which have been crafted with great imagination

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THE UNION BUDGET 2024-25 is a transformative and progressive blueprint for India's future. Emphasising employment generation, fiscal prudence, and economic reforms, this Budget caters to all aspects of the economy and the lives and livelihoods of our people. It addresses key pillars essential for moving towards Viksit Bharat—a futuristic, inclusive, and balanced India. This visionary and growth-oriented Budget not only responds to the present day needs of the country but also aligns with Prime Minister Narendra Modi's long-term vision of Viksit Bharat by 2047. By balancing policymaking with the judicious use of resources, the Budget builds on the foundation of the last decade, pivoting growth from one that is investment-led to one that is consumption-led.

It is particularly noteworthy that the Budget has prioritised employment generation—including the doubling of the ceiling for MUDRA loans for entrepreneurs—by providing the right kind of incentives to industry and the private sector. This will impart a much-needed boost to the Indian economy. The Budget is imagina-



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tive in its scope and emphasis and is the best blend of policymaking and judicious use of resources.

Tax concessions, especially for the middle class, and incentives for job creation are salutary steps. In this context, the abolition of angel tax will help generate momentum in the start-up economy.

At the same time, this Budget has batted for fiscal prudence. In turn, this reinforces macroeconomic stability and strengthens the hand of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) in managing monetary policy—especially in effecting interest rate cuts and thereby lowering the cost of capital.

The nine priority areas listed by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman represent an accurate assessment and policy emphasis of what the Indian economy needs as the country pushes forward towards its goal of becoming a \$5-trillion economy and beyond. They are: productivity and resilience in agriculture; employment & skilling; inclusive human resource development and social justice; manufacturing & services; urban development; energy security; infrastructure; innovation, research & development; and next-generation reforms. These are a judicious mix of steps needed to ensure that our human resources are utilised